PORTFOLIO PROJECT · SYNTHETIC DATA: NORTHLAKE DONOR NETWORK (FICTIONAL)

Which campaigns recruit donors who return?

Campaign spend joined to the donors and appointments it produced. Cost per new donor is half the story; cost per retained donor is the other half.

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Fiscal year (April to March)

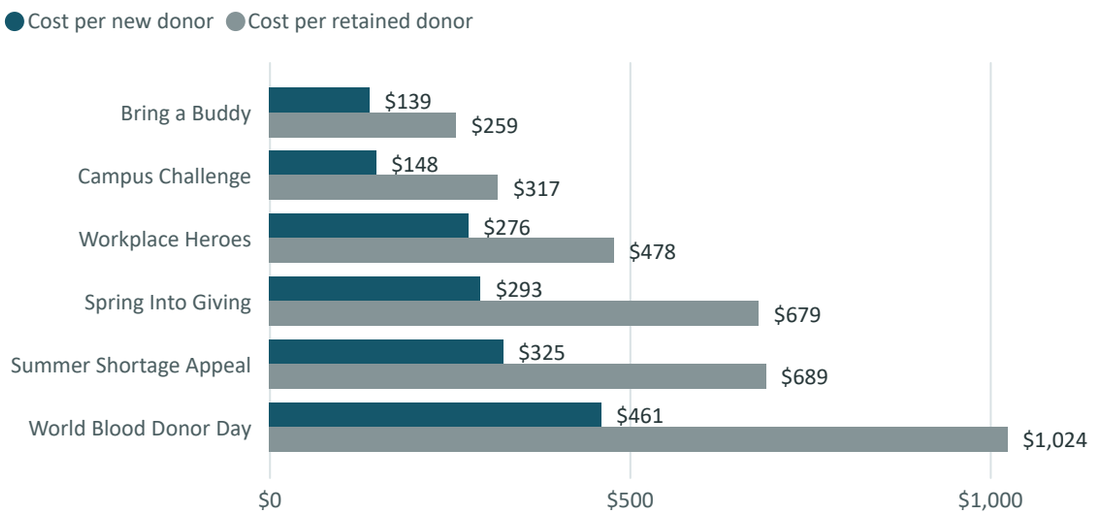
FY25/26

Attribution: a first-time donor counts toward a campaign when they joined through one of its channels during its run dates. 12-month return is reported only for recruits with a full year of follow-up.

Campaign spend	New donors	Cost / new donor	12-month return	Show rate	Reactivated
Media + programme	First-time, attributed	Spend ÷ new donors	Gave again in 12 mo	Attended ÷ booked	Back after 12+ months
$628K	**2,321**	**$271**	**45.6%**	**84.6%**	**3,359**

Cost per new donor vs cost per retained donor

Recruitment campaigns, all years. Retained = gave again within 12 months. Ignores the year slicer.



Funnel by channel

Selected year. Spend, reach, bookings and the donors who stayed.

Channel	Spend	Booked	Shows	Donors	Return	Cost/kept
Paid social	$224,770	1,043	84.9%	885	42.1%	$603
Email & SMS	$128,937	565	84.8%	479	47.0%	$573
Search	$96,451	357	83.8%	299	47.2%	$684
Community event	$81,664	115	80.0%	92	56.5%	$1,570
Friend referral	$48,564	326	85.0%	277		
Campus drive	$47,613	339	85.3%	289		
Total	**$628,000**	**2,745**	**84.6%**	**2,321**	**45.6%**	**$594**

Campaign results

Selected year. Blank return = recruits do not yet have 12 months of follow-up.

Campaign	Objective	Spend	New donors	Cost / new	12-mo return	Cost / retained	Reactivated
Summer Shortage Appeal 2025	Acquisition	$238,000	725	$328	45.5%	$721	
World Blood Donor Day 2025	Awareness	$161,000	326	$494	45.7%	$1,081	
Campus Challenge 2025	Acquisition	$109,000	678	$161			
Bring a Buddy 2026	Acquisition	$71,000	496	$143			
Total		**$628,000**	**2,321**	**$271**	**45.6%**	**$594**	**3,359**

What this means

1. Rank campaigns on cost per retained donor. Bring a Buddy and Campus Challenge recruit a retained donor for a quarter to a third of what World Blood Donor Day costs; Workplace Heroes looks expensive per new donor but its recruits come back most often.

2. Shift a test budget toward referral and workplace programmes. Move 15% of awareness spend for one cycle and compare cost per retained donor against the prior year.

3. Fix the click-to-booking step first. It is the largest drop in every digital channel; a booking-page test is cheaper than buying more clicks.

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Do SMS reminders reduce missed appointments?

Randomised test, Sep 2025 to Feb 2026: half of booked appointments received an SMS reminder on top of the email. Plus the effect of reactivation campaigns on lapsed donors.

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No-show: email
Control arm
11.2%

No-show: SMS
Treatment arm
8.6%

Reduction
SMS vs email only
2.5 pts

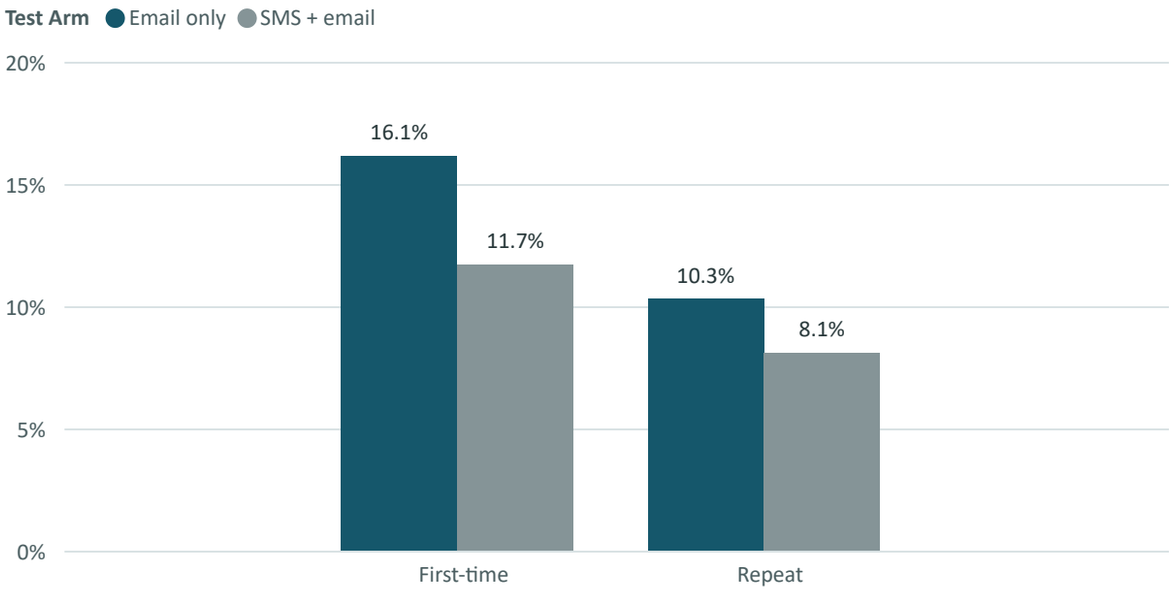
95% CI
Reduction, unpooled
2.1 to …

Significance
Two-sided
p < 0.0…

Extra visits / yr
From fewer no-shows
2,981

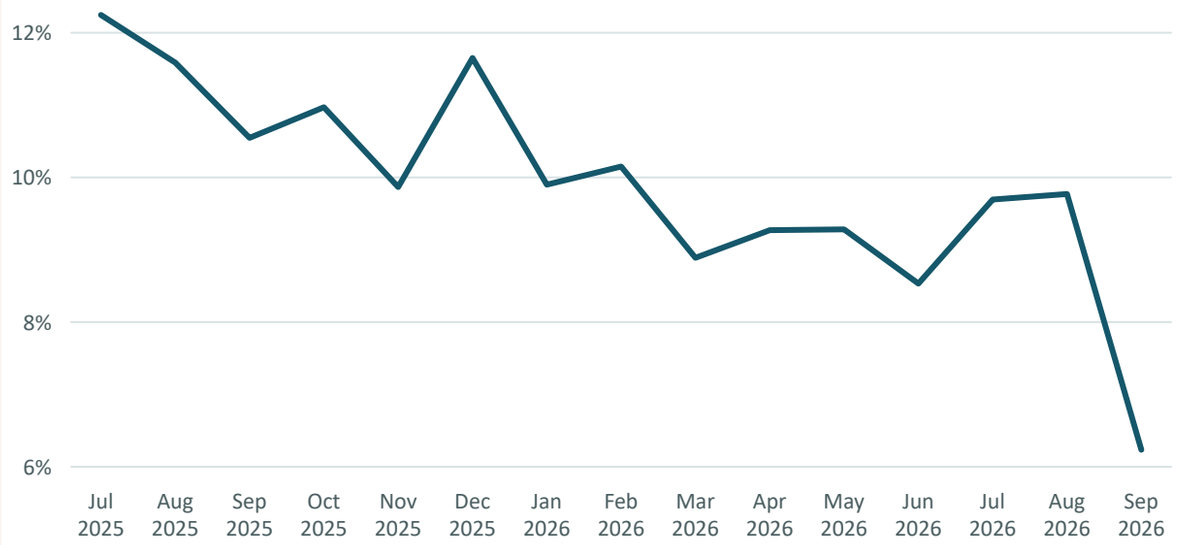
No-show rate by donor type and test arm

The SMS effect is largest for first-time donors.



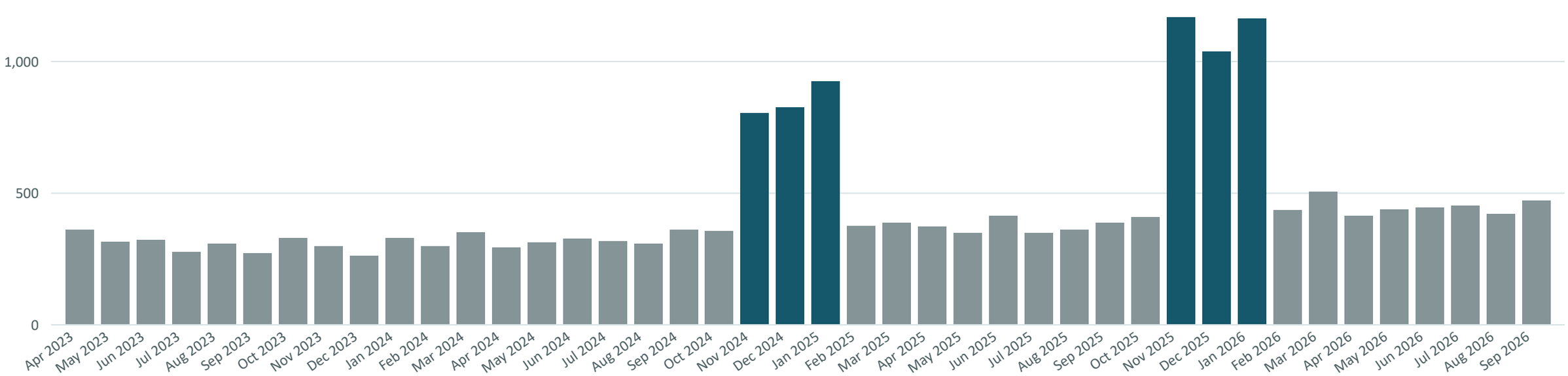
Monthly no-show rate, all appointments

Jul 2025 to Sep 2026. Test ran Sep 2025 to Feb 2026; SMS for everyone from March 2026.



Donors returning after 12+ months away

Dark blue = months when the We Miss You reactivation campaign ran.



Avg per campaign month
Reactivated donors
985

Avg per other month
Reactivated donors
358

Lift in campaign months
Campaign vs other months
175%

Cost per reactivated donor
All reactivation campaigns
$16.08

Add visual title

Method and recommendations

Test design: appointments were randomly assigned to email only or SMS + email. No-show rates are compared with a two-proportion z-test (pooled standard error) and a 95% confidence interval on the difference. All calculations are DAX measures in this model.

Keep SMS reminders on and add a second reminder for first-time donors, who miss the most appointments. Test it the same way before rolling out.

Run reactivation twice a year. Reactivated donors cost a fraction of a new recruit; a spring wave ahead of the summer shortage adds supply when it is most needed.